reflects on the role of religion in education: 'What should be the ideological basis of education? Whether the Islamic conception of universal brotherhood of man, social democracy and social justice should constitute this ideological basis – cultivation of democratic virtues, i.e. tolerance, self help, self-sacrifice, human kindliness etc and the consciousness of common citizenship as opposed to provincial exclusiveness' (Government of Pakistan 1947). This is an early portrayal of how Islam is to act as the glue to a nation made up of diverse provincial and regional characteristics. Religion however is not enough and the role of Urdu as common language, propagated through the schools, is also seen as a way of binding the nation together. Rahman (2004), in his analysis of the education policies of Pakistan at its independence, highlights how the education system through its imposition of language and religion attempted to counter 'ethnic and religious divisions' but never challenged the 'socio-economic class divides' which went in favour of the ruling elite (2004, p. 9). English therefore retained its precolonial position as the language of the educated elite despite the imposition of Urdu as the national language, thereby creating an education hierarchy from the time of independence.

Under the rule of the first military dictator, General Ayub Khan, the Commission on National Education was convened in 1959 with the aim of redefining 'the philosophy of education', emphasizing its importance in developing the 'national character' of Pakistan (Hayes 1987, p. 45).[1] Two priorities characterize Khan's education policy: national integration/homogenization and modernization. The national integration part is discussed in a chapter on the role of education in character building, with the latter notion centred on good citizenship. According to Rubina Saigol patriotism was to be inculcated through the schools and policymakers recommended that primary schools should open each day with the national anthem in the assembly, accompanied by the hoisting of the national flag and short talks emphasizing patriotism and character building. Saigol goes on to describe that 'A very strong emphasis should be placed on the national language at the primary stage and reading should build "desirable attitudes", "good character traits" and "industrious habits". Religious instruction should be compulsory at this stage' (Saigol 2003, p. 11). In order for Pakistan to develop, premodern identities rooted in regional and communal consciousness had to be shed. Saigol explains how religious difference and otherness were not central components of this form of nationalism and that

> religious tolerance and diversity of faiths were among the values espoused in Ayub's period as part of becoming a modern and secular polity. In a history